Movement across finite clause boundaries: Hyper-raising in Brazilian Portuguese

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1 Core data and claim

- Brazilian Portuguese (BP) allows raising out of finite embedded clauses, hyper-raising (HR) in the sense of Ura (1994), (2).[1]

(1) Parece que **a** **Julia** tratou mal **as** **meninas**
Seem.3SG that the Julia treat.3SG.PST bad the.PL girls
"It seems Julia was rude to the girls."

(2) Hyper-raising in BP
a. **A** **Julia** parece [que _ tratou mal as meninas]
The Julia seem.3SG that _ treat.3SG.PST bad the.PL girls
b. **As** **meninas** parecem/parece [que a Julia tratou mal _]
The.PL girls seem.PL/seem.SG that the Julia treat.3SG.PST bad _
"It seems Julia was rude to the girls."

- (1) no hyper-raising, matrix SpecTP is either empty (EPP checked independently) or filled by covert expletive.[2]
- (2)(a) HR of an embedded subject.
- (2)(c) HR of an embedded object.
- HR of subject and of object may trigger plural agreement with the matrix verb.
- **To be argued for**: (2) is derived through movement *and* the final landing site of the HR DP is matrix SpecTP.
- Movement across finite clause boundaries raises four issues:

[1] I thank Ivona Kučerová for very valuable feedback given on this work and earlier versions of this talk.

[2] Abbreviations: SG = singular, PL = plural, F = female, M = male, 1 to 3 = 1st, 2nd, 3rd person, DET = determiner, GER = gerund, PST = past, PART = participle. Grammatical gender features on nouns are omitted. Singular marking on determiners is not glossed unless relevant.

(3) **The phase boundary issue**
Finite clause boundaries constitute strong phase boundaries (Chomsky, 2008). Extraction out of a finite clause boundary requires intermediate movement into the embedded phase edge. There is no transparent mechanism for this movement in (2).

(4) **The improper movement issue**
Extraction out of a finite clause boundary requires intermediate movement to the phase edge. The phase edge is defined as the specifier of the phase head, e.g., SpecCP. The phase edge is an A'-position. The final landing site of the HR DP in (2) is SpecTP, an A-position. HR thus requires A'-movement followed by A-movement, contra the Ban on Improper Movement.

(5) **The optionality issue**
HR seems to be entirely optional, both the HR examples and their in-situ counterparts are grammatical. Optional movement is a problem for theories assuming strictly motivated syntactic operations.

(6) **The activity issue**
Finite clause boundaries are phase domains where the licensing conditions of DPs are complete, e.g., case and ϕ-features are checked. A DP with checked features is rendered inactive for movement. HR requires further movement of a DP that has already been licensed.

1.1 Proposal in a nutshell

- HR is the result of:
  - DP internal properties.
  - The availability of discourse driven movement in BP.
- DPs in BP carry features that are always active for movement, e.g., DP can enter into multiple agree relations.
- In particular, a discoursive (δ) feature probe (in the sense of Miyagawa 2009) can unlock phases (Halpert, 2019).

-> **HR is not a result of clausal properties, but the result of nominal properties and the availability of discourse driven operations in narrow syntax**.

2 HR is A-movement[3]

(7) **HR is banned from complex DP islands.**

a. ***Aquelas meninas**$_i$ parecem que a delegada ouviu [o depoimento de
Those.F girls seem.PL that the deputy.F hear.3SG.PST the report of
que a Julia tratou mal $__i$]
that the Julia treat.3SG.PST bad $_$

[3]Arguments below also hold crosslinguistically, see Ura (1994, 1995); Fong (2019); Carstens (2011); Alboiu and Hill (2016); Lee and Yip (2020).

b. Parece que a delegada ouviu [o depoimento de que a Julia
Seem.SG that the deputy.F hear.3SG.PST the report of that the Julia
tratou mal **aquelas meninas**]
treat.3SG.PST bad those.F girls
"It seems the deputy heard the report that Julia was rude to those girls."

(8) **HR is banned from coordination islands, allowed in across-the-board movement**

a. ***As meninas**$_i$ parecem que a Julia tratou mal [_$_i$ e os
The.PL girls seem.PL that the Julia treat.3SG.PST bad _ and the.PL
meninos]
boys
"It seems Julia was rude to the boys and the girls."

b. **As meninas**$_i$ parecem que a Julia ofendeu _$_i$ e tratou
The.PL girls seem.PL that the Julia insult.3SG.PST _ and treat.3SG.PST
mal _$_i$
bad _
"It seems Julia was rude to and insulted the girls."

(9) **HR out of an idiom chunk maintains the idiomatic reading** (Nunes, 2008)

a. Parece que a vaca foi para o brejo
Seems that the cow go.3SG.PST to the bog

b. A vaca parece que _ foi para o brejo
the cow seems that _ go.3SG.PST to the bog
"It seems *things didn't go well.*", lit "It seems the cow went into the bog".

(10) **HR DP may provide a new antecedent for binding**

a. *Em **suas**$_i$ próprias casas] parece que a Julia tratou
In their.F.PL own.F.PL houses.PL.F seem.3PL that the Julia treat.3SG.PST
mal **as meninas**
bad the.PL girls
"It seems that Julia was rude to the girls in their own homes."

b. **As meninas**$_i$ [em **suas**$_i$ próprias casas] parecem que a Julia
The.PL girls in their.F.PL own.F.PL houses.PL.F seem.3PL that the Julia
tratou mal _
treat.3SG.PST bad _

(11) **HR is tied to scope ambiguity**

a. Parece que **duas pessoas** ganharam a loteria
Seem.3SG that two.F people.PL win.3PL.PST the lottery
"It seems like two people won the lottery".
* Two > seem, seem > two

b. **Duas pessoas** parecem que _ ganharam a loteria
Two.F people.PL seem.3PL that _ win.3PL.PST the lottery
"Two people seem like they won the lottery".
Two > seem, seem > two

- I take these four arguments to support the hypothesis that **HR is movement with A-properties**.

3 Proposal

- The proposal has two core pieces[4]:

(12) **Brazilian Portuguese has hyperactive DPs**

(13) **Phase-unlocking by discoursive movement**

3.1 Part I: Hyperactive DPs

- I follow Carstens and Diercks (2009)'s insight that a DP may enter in more than one agree relation if it carries a [-intepretable, +valued] feature.
- A DP carrying a [-intepretable, +valued] feature is rendered hyperactive because it retains active features even when its phase is complete.
- Specifically, I argue the feature driving hyperactivity in BP is Number.
- Argument: plurality in spoken BP is largely a grammatical feature, thus [-intepretable, +valued].
- Evidence I: BP displays bare singular DPs that are semantically plural, (14)

(14) Bare singulars in BP

a. Tem muito **professor** nesse protesto
Have.3S many.M.SG teacher.SG at-this protest
"There are many teachers in this protest."

b. Veio muita **criança** na festa
Came.3S many.F.SG child.SG at-the party
"A lot of children came to the party."

- Evidence II: Subject-predicate plural agreement is optional in spoken BP.

(15) Optional plural agreement in BP

a. Eles **foi/foram** **tudo/todos** embora já
They.M.PL went.3S/went.3PL all.M.SG/all.M.PL away already
"They have all gone away already."

b. Aqueles jogador **jogou/jogaram** muito bem no jogo domingo
Those.PL player.SG played.3SG/played.3PL very well at-the game sunday
"Those players played really well at the match on Sunday."

- I argue Number is a hyperactive feature in BP.
- Hyperactivity is accounted for, but that is not enough: how can a DP move across a finite clause boundary?

[4]For a discussion on alternative proposals to HR, see the appendix

3.2 Part II: Discoursive movement

- Discourse driven movement is a signature property of BP, i.e., topic-subjects as in (16) (Pontes, 1987; Avelar and Galves, 2011, 2014; Avelar and Cyrino, 2018; de Andrade and Galves, 2014).

(16) Discourse driven movement in BP[5,6,7]

a. Tá nascendo (o) dente daquelas crianças
Be.3SG born.GER (the) teeth.SG of-those.F children.F
"Those children are getting their first teeth", lit. "Teeth is being born in those children".

b. **Aquelas crianças tão** nascendo (o) dente
Those.F children be.3PL born.GER (the) teeth.SG
"Those children are getting their first teeth", lit. "Those children are *borning* teeth".

c. Toca jazz nesses bares
Play.3S jazz at-these.M bar.PL
"They play jazz at these bars", lit "(Someone) plays jazz at these bars".

d. **Esses bares tocam** jazz
These.M bar.M.PL play.3PL jazz
"They play jazz at these bars", lit "These bars play jazz".

- Optional discourse movement is attested with other syntactic relations, for example, with wh-movement:

(17) Optional wh-movement in BP

a. O presidente foi [pra onde] semana passada?
The president.M went.3SG to where week last

b. [Pra onde] o presidente _ foi semana passada?
To where the president.M _ went week last
"Where did the president go last week?"

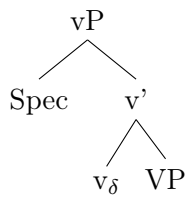
- I propose that HR belongs to a larger class of optional movement operations in BP, namely those driven by a discoursive feature probe (a δ probe in the sense of Miyagawa 2009, 2017).
- The function of δ is driving information structure building operations.
- I argue HR verbs are special in that they carry a δ feature probe that may but does not need to probe lower DPs available for movement.

(18) Hyper raising verbs in BP

[5]The derivation of examples in (16) is beyond the scope of this talk. Several proposals exist together with an ongoing debate on whether the subjects in these structures are derived through movement or base generation. I follow the former. For an in depth discussion, I refer the reader to the works just cited and to the appendix of this handout.

[6]An important note on (a) and (c): these are impersonal constructions where the subject of the matrix verb is, presumably, a covert expletive. Generally, discourse driven movement is restricted to impersonal constructions. This is unsurprising given that the final landing site of the discourse-moved DP is SpecTP and *ec* is - presumably - late-inserted as a last resort operation to check the EPP feature on T. In short, SpecTP is empty at the moment the DP is discourse-moved.

[7]The fact the PPs undergoing movement in these examples become DPs at SpecTP is an open problem, see Avelar and Cyrino (2018).



4 Part III: Phase Unlocking

- Furthermore, I propose HR verbs in BP may unlock phases and raise elements to the specifier of vP.
- Namely, the δ probe in v may access phase-internal elements through agreement with the full embedded CP, in the vein of Phase Unlocking as in Halpert (2019) plus the proposal for cyclical cross-clausal movement in Dinka put forward in Van Urk and Richards (2015).
- **Evidence for v/CP agreement**: ban on CP fronting in HR configurations and wh-movement configurations (CP is frozen for movement once δ agrees with it), (19). CP fronting is allowed in BP, (c).

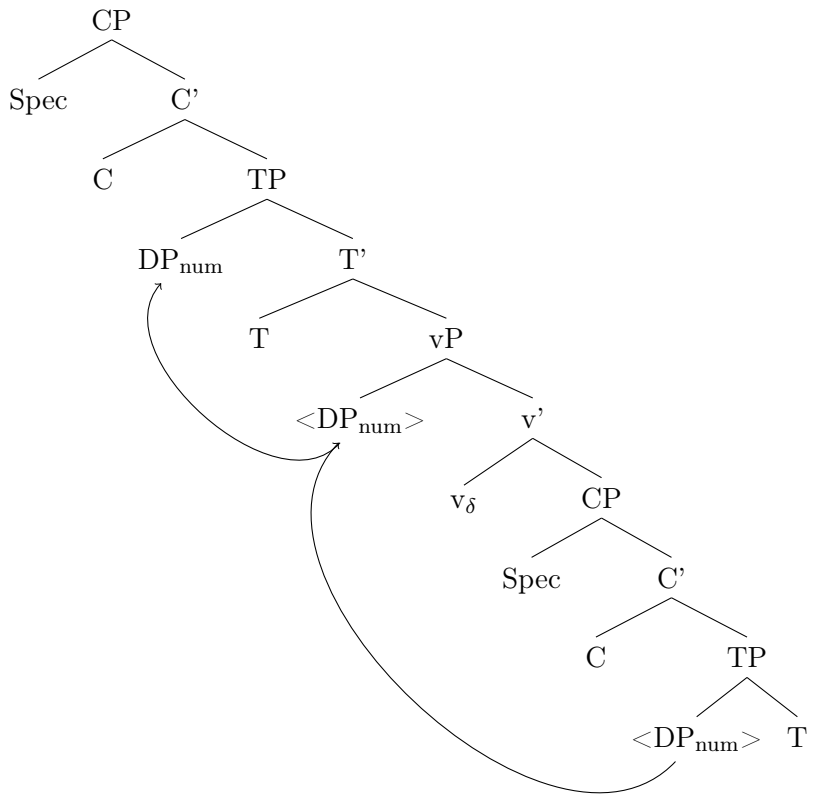
(19) HR freezes CPs for movement

a. O gato parece [que _ fugiu]
the cat seems that _ escaped

b. *[Que _ fugiu] o gato parece _
That _ escaped the cat seems _

c. [Que o gato fugiu] parece óbvio _
That the cat escaped seems obvious _
"That the cat ran away seems obvious."

- When δ unlocks the embedded clause, it agrees with the hyper-active number feature of a DP, probing the DP and raising it to matrix SpecvP.
- Importantly, no feature valuation happens in the agree relation involving δ and the embedded DP: Num is always +valued.
- Instances of optional movement are a result of [-interpretable, +valued] features that may freely enter into any number (including zero) of agree relations with no feature valuation.



- The derivation in the tree above solves all 4 issues raised by HR.
- Hyperactivity is handled by assumptions on the inner structure of DPs in BP.
- The phasehood issue is handled by δ agreeing with and unlocking the embedded CP.
- The improper movement issue is similarly solved by phase unlocking: since there is no phase boundary restricting movement, the DP never undergoes A'-movement into SpecCP, instead it goes through two instances of A-movement: to matrix SpecvP and matrix SpecTP.
- The optionality issue is accounted for through the proposal that optionality is a result of hyperactive features that require no feature valuation.

5 Predictions

5.1 DPs without NumP

- Prediction: DPs lacking NumP may not undergo HR since they lack the hyperactive feature.
- DPs without NumP or where Num is not visible: bare nouns (Munn and Schmitt, 2002) and DPs in inalienable possession configurations.[8]

[8] I assume that DPs in inalienable possession configurations are derived through movement as proposed in Landau (1999). In short, the possessor in (20) is merged at the specifier of the possessee DP (from where it is raised), blocking Num from being visible to clause level operations.

- Prediction is borne out: none of these DPs may undergo HR.

(20) Inalienable possession and HR

a. A Ana quebrou **a perna**
The Ana broke the. leg.F
"Ana broke her leg."

b. Parece [que a Ana quebrou **a perna**]
Seem that the Ana broke the leg.F
"It seems Ana broke her leg."

c. **A perna**$_i$ parece [que a Ana quebrou **t**$_i$]
The leg.F seem that the Ana broke t
"It seems Ana broke a leg (belonging to someone)"

- The interpretation of inalienable possession is not available in (c), the only interpretation available is that Ana broke someone's leg.

- Similarly, HR of bare singulars is banned:

(21) Bare singulars I

a. Ele tratou **criança** mal
He treat.3SG child.F.SG. bad
"He was mean to children."

b. Parece [que ele tratou **criança** mal]
Seem that he treat.3SG child.F.SG. bad

c. ***Criança** parece [que ele tratou **t**$_i$ mal]
Child.F.SG seem that he treat.3SG t bad
"It seems he was mean to children."

- We can further test bare singulars with what Munn and Schmitt (2002) call the *reprise-commentaire* configurations:

(22) Bare singulars II

a. A chefe comprou um carro, **carro** que ela vendeu uma semana depois
the boss.F bought.3SG one.M car, car that she sold.3SG one.F week later
"The boss bought a car, a car she sold a week after."

b. *A chefe comprou um carro, **carro** parece que ela vendeu _ uma
the. boss bought.3SG one.M car, car seems that she sold.3SG _ one.F
semana depois
week later
"The boss bought a car, a car that it seems she sold a week after."

5.2 Non DPs should not move

- If HR requires a hyperactive feature and this feature is on D, elements where D is not visible should not HR.

- This prediction is borne out: CPs and PPs can not be hyper raised in BP.

(23) Argument CPs may not undergo HR

a. Parece que $_{CP}$ [o Palmeiras ter perdido o jogo] incomodou muito
Seems that the Palmeiras have lost the game bother.3SG.PST very
meu avô
my.M grandfather

b. *[O Palmeiras ter perdido o jogo] parece que _ incomodou muito
the Palmeiras have lost.PART the game seems.3SG that _ bother.3SG.PST very
meu avô
my.M grandfather
"It seems that Palmeiras[9] losing the match bothered my grandfather quite a lot."

(24) Hyper raising restrictions in BP: argument PPs

a. *Para as meninas parece que a Julia contou _ o que
To the girls seems.3SG that the Julia told.3S the what happen.3SG.PST
aconteceu

b. Parece que a Julia contou para as meninas o que aconteceu
Seems that the Julia told.3S to the girls the what happen.3SG.PST
"It seems Julia told the girls what happened."[10]

6 Conclusions and open questions

- I proposed an account of HR based on nominal properties and lexical properties of HR verbs.
- HR is an instance of discourse driven movement enabled by DP hyperactivity.
- Discourse driven movement is optional in BP because it involves no feature valuation.
- Open questions:
  - Why is HR restricted to arguments?
  - Is HR attested in other varieties of Portuguese? Prediction: not in European Portuguese (no hyperactive DPs, obligatory plural concord).
  - Can the proposal be extended to other instances of HR crosslinguistically? (Yes for Bantu, unclear for Romanian, Mongolian, Vietnamese and Cantonese).
  - Crosslinguistically, it seems HR verbs are within a class of non-agentive/attitude verbs, why is that?
  - How can object HR violate minimality? (1c)

[9] Brazilian soccer team

[10] Importantly, (a) is grammatical when the dislocated PP is interpreted as a contrastive topic or a focused DP. In that case, the PP is always pronounced with a raised prosodic contour. Relevant for the current argument is the fact that contrastive topic and focus constructions in BP do not display any of the signature properties of HR, as shown in the previous section. When the sentence is question is grammatical, it does not pass any of the movement tests discussed nor does it maintain idiom readings.

- In the system proposed, δ agrees both with the embedded CP and with the HR DP, what is exactly this agreement operation?

- Take home messages:

(25) **Cross-clausal movement is not necessarily driven by clausal properties.**
Hyper-raising in BP can be accounted for through the nominal domain, there is no need to argue for some form of clause reduction. The gain is a system that is strictly derivational, the loss is a system that is counter-cyclical.

(26) **Optional movement is movement with no feature valuation.**
Hyper-raising is part of a broad group of syntactic movement that is optional in BP, the optionality is a reflex of the feature involved being [-intepretable, +valued.].

(27) **(Some) discourse related operations are part of narrow syntax.**
Movement for the purposes of information structure building is present in narrow syntax via the δ feature probe. The features that may agree with δ and the heads endowed with it vary crosslinguistically (Miyagawa, 2009, 2017). In BP, I argued δ may agree with Num and is present in the v head.

7 Appendix

7.1 Alternative proposals and the problem with clausal solutions to HR

- The empirical picture: HR is movement with A-properties across finite clause boundaries.
- HR is optional.
- The problems in (3), (4), (5) and (6) need thus to be addressed.
- Current literature proposes different solutions to these problems.
- As nicely summarized in Lee and Yip (2020) these solutions fall within three groups
  - Family I: **Featural distinction on A/A'-positions**
    - Spec,CP as A-positions (Obata and Epstein, 2011; Fong, 2019).
    - Hyper-raising as A'-movement with A-movement effects (Alboiu and Hill, 2016).
  - Family II: **Conditioned deactivation of the PIC**.
    - Selective opacity of domains: Phase unlocking (Halpert, 2019).
    - Deactivation of phasehood: (i) Defective CPs (Nunes, 2008), (ii) Exfoliation (Pesetsky, 2016).
  - Family III: **Parametrization on Multiple Case**.
    - Parametrization on Multiple Agree (Halpert, 2019)
    - SpecTP may not be a case position (Ura, 1994).
- Most proposals rely on some special clausal property of the embedded clause (e.g., incomplete T in Nunes' work, SpecCP as an A-position in Fong's).
- The special property of the embedded clause is always some form of incompleteness (e.g., it can not license DPs as it lacks the necessary feature probes/heads/structure).
- A second component present in (some of) these proposals is the special properties of the matrix HR verb (e.g., the evidentiality feature in Alboiu and Hill (2016).
- Rarely, the DP domain is associated with HR.
- This is surprising given the hyperactivity problem.
- Handling the hyperactivity problem through clausal properties encompasses arguing for clause incompleteness (or clause reduction in the sense of Wurmbrand 2019).
- If HR is a clausal problem, it follows that the embedded clause is necessarily unable to satisfy the conditions for licensing the HR DP (since there is nothing special/incomplete about the HR DPs themselves).
- Clause incompleteness raises non-trivial issues:
  - If HR is optional it follows that embedded clauses in HR language may or may not be incomplete.
  - Derivationally, it is entirely unclear why and how a clause would be built in its incomplete form without any look-ahead mechanism.

- Moreover, ungrammatical counter-examples - where the embedded clause is incomplete and no HR is present - are expected.
- Since HR is optional, this is not the case: the in-situ counterpart of HR is always grammatical (contrast between (a) and (b) in (1)).
- The clause incompleteness solution is to claim that, in the in-situ example (1a), the embedded clause is complete, while in the HR example (1b) the clause is incomplete, deriving HR.
- Empirically, there is no way to falsify this theory: syntax builds a complete or incomplete clause depending on what will be built at the higher structure.

7.2 Hyperactivity of Num and its position within DP

- Obligatory plural concord - as in (a) below - a general property of Romance, is no longer present in BP:

(28) Optional plural within a DP

a.	As	crianças	educadas
	DET.F.PL	child.F.PL	polite.F.PL
b.	As	criança	educada
	DET.F.PL	child.F.SG	polite.F.SG
c.	*A	crianças	educadas
	DET.F.SG	child.F.PL	polite.F.PL
d.	*As	criança	educadas
	DET.F.PL	child.F.SG	polite.F.PL
e.	*As	crianças	educada
	DET.F.PL	child.F.PL	polite.F.SG

"The polite children."

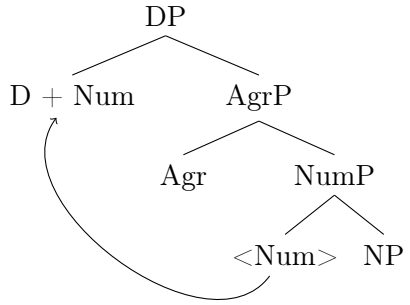
- Crucially, if D is plural, every lower element within the DP may be singular or plural.
- If D is singular, no plural elements are allowed, (c).
- If D is plural, all elements must be either all plural or all singular, SG + PL combinations are banned, (d, e).
- Moreover, a DP with plural D and subsequent singular Ns may or may not trigger PL verbal agreement:

(29) As criança educada foi/foram tudo/todas pra escola já
DET.F.PL child.F.SG polite.F.SG went.3SG/went/.PL all.SG/all.F.PL to-DET.F school already
'The polite children have all already gone to school.'

- Certain morphossyntactic domains are sensible to semantic plurality, but others not.
- In short, plural marking in BP is optional though its optionality is restricted to syntactic structure (D dictates how the lower NPs are marked for number).

- I take the outlined facts to point to two properties of BP: i) Num raises to D, ii) Num carries a hyperactive feature.
- Num-to-D raising is motivated by the fact D is the relevant syntactic domain for semantic plurality.
- Hyperactivity is motivated by the optionality of plural marking + multiple agree between HR DPs and the matrix/embedded verbs.
- Moreover, hyperactivity is motivated by the fact BP also displays unexpected movement patterns much like Bantu topicalization (further discussion on this in the next section).
- Assuming the proposed DP structure for BP in Munn and Schmitt (2002), I propose Num undergoes head movement into D, as in (30):

(30) Num-to-D raising in BP



- The DP structure proposed in (30) together with the assumption that number is [-interpretable, +valued] in BP renders DPs in BP hyperactive for clausal operations: the Num feature may enter into agree relations indefinitely.

7.3 Hyperactivity outside of HR

- The idea that DPs are hyperactive for movement in BP predicts more instances of 'unexpected' DP movement.
- As discussed, one signature property of BP is its discourse-oriented properties (Pontes, 1987; Avelar and Galves, 2011, 2014; Avelar and Cyrino, 2018).
- In short, in certain configurations, BP allows non-agents to become structural subjects.
- The literature calls these topic-subjects.
- I propose topic-subjects are a result of the hyper-active number features on D plus the existence of the active δ probe in BP.
- Prediction: the restrictions on HR should apply to topic-subjects (no PPs, no CPs, no bare nouns).
- Prediction is borne out for PPs and bare nouns:

(31) a. As ruas do centro não tão passando carro
The.PL street.PL of.the centre no be.3S passing car.SG
"Cars are not being allowed into the streets downtown", lit "the streets downtown are not passing cars".

b. ***Nas** ruas do centro não tão passando carro
In.the.PL street.PL of.the centre no be.3S pass.GER car.SG

c. ***Carro** não tá passando nas ruas do centro
Car.SG no be.3SG pass.GER in.the.PL street.PL of.the centre
Intended: "Cars are not being allowed into the streets downtown", lit "the streets downtown are not passing cars".

7.4 Recursion

If DPs are hyperactive and HR verbs unlock phases, nothing stops recursive HR, e.g., a DP entering into multiple probe-goal relations with multiple δ probes.

Prediction is borne out:

(32) **O prefeito** parece [que _ acabou [que _ calhou que [_ perdeu a eleição]]]
The mayor seems that _ end-up that _ conveniently-end-up that _ lost the election
"It seems that in the end the mayor conveniently ended up losing the election."

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